

A PROPOSAL FOR DR. SHUSHANNAH SMITH

Oakwood does not need another computer lab. It needs an *AI production studio*.

A 10-seat lab where Mathematics & Computer Science students at Oakwood University don't *study* AI — they *ship* it. Apps, agents, research artifacts, and campus tools, in weeks instead of years. Built for HBCU excellence and the velocity of 2026.

10 seats 4 budget paths 90 day launch Local + Cloud

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A note on numbers. *These are strategic targets shaped around current 2026 hardware: the GB10 Grace Blackwell Superchip in the \$4,699 NVIDIA DGX Spark, the AMD Ryzen AI Max+ 395 in the Framework Desktop (\$1,999–\$2,851 depending on storage and memory at 128 GB), and the Jetson AGX Thor for physical AI. Final line items should be calibrated against fresh vendor quotes, education pricing through NVIDIA Academic and Apple Education, and the room's existing electrical and network reality before procurement. The principle is constant: ten reliable creator seats, meaningful shared local compute, and infrastructure that lets work be shown.*

"By the time a student finishes the spine, the portfolio is already there. They didn't make it for a grade. They made it because they could."

OUTCOME

8 *shipped*
ARTIFACTS PER STUDENT

"The youngest builders in 2026 aren't waiting for permission. They combine tools, focus on a real problem, and ship — fast. Oakwood gives that energy a home."

Oakwood students don't need to catch up. With the right room, the right machines, and the right faculty mentorship, they can lead — and the lab is the visible proof that they do.

WHY THIS MATTERS AT AN HBCU

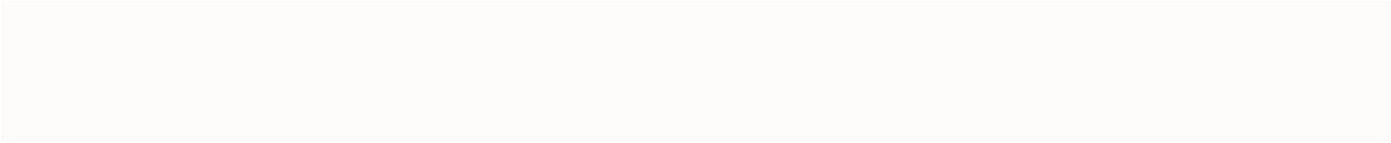
Oakwood's graduates will work in environments where AI decisions affect their own communities — health, finance, criminal justice, education, civic systems. Teaching governance as a craft means producing builders who understand the weight of what they're building. That's not a warning. It's a competitive advantage and a moral one.

The lab makes Oakwood a place that produces the people federal agencies, healthcare systems, and Huntsville's defense and biotech ecosystem are looking for right now — and not finding enough of.

THE INVITATION

Oakwood has
the students.
Oakwood has
the mission.
Now is the moment.

A lab like this is most valuable in the year before everyone has one. 2026 is that year. The right configuration depends on Oakwood's funding, room, and the format Dr. Smith's department wants the program to take — those answers shape the next deliverable.



Briefing

"Oakwood does not need another computer lab. It needs an AI production studio." — Prepared as a working document for Dr. Shushannah Smith, Chair, Department of Mathematics & Computer Science, Oakwood University, May 2026.

References

NVIDIA DGX Spark / GB10 Framework Desktop AI Max+ 395 NVIDIA Jetson AGX Thor Apple Mac Studio M-series

Document

final package · 18 May 2026 [PDF briefing](#) [PowerPoint deck](#) [Full bundle](#) 10-seat configuration HBCU context Huntsville, Alabama